

Numbers 20:1-17a:

¹And the people of Israel, the whole congregation, came into the wilderness of Zin in the first month, and the people stayed in Kadesh. And **Miriam died there and was buried there.**

²Now there was no water for the congregation. And they assembled themselves together against Moses and against Aaron. ³And the people quarreled with Moses and said, “**Would that we had perished when our brothers perished before the LORD!**” ⁴Why have you brought the assembly of the LORD into this wilderness, that we should die here, both we and our cattle? ⁵And why have you made us come up out of Egypt to bring us to this evil place? It is no place for grain or figs or vines or pomegranates, and there is no water to drink.” ⁶Then Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly to the entrance of the tent of meeting and fell on their faces. And the glory of the LORD appeared to them, ⁷and the LORD spoke to Moses, saying, ⁸“Take the staff, and assemble the congregation, you and Aaron your brother, and tell the rock before their eyes to yield its water. So you shall bring water out of the rock for them and give drink to the congregation and their cattle.” ⁹And Moses took the staff from before the LORD, as he commanded him.

¹⁰Then Moses and Aaron gathered the assembly together before the rock, and he said to them, “Hear now, you rebels: shall we bring water for you out of this rock?” ¹¹And Moses lifted up his hand and struck the rock with his staff twice, and water came out abundantly, and the congregation drank, and their livestock. ¹²And the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, “Because you did not believe in me, to uphold me as holy in the eyes of the people of Israel, **therefore you shall not bring this assembly into the land that I have given them.**” ¹³These are the waters of Meribah, where the people of Israel quarreled with the LORD, and through them he showed himself holy.

¹⁴Moses sent messengers from Kadesh to the king of Edom: “Thus says your brother Israel: You know all the hardship that we have met: ¹⁵how our fathers went down to Egypt, and we lived in Egypt a long time. And the Egyptians dealt harshly with us and our fathers. ¹⁶And when we cried to the LORD, he heard our voice and sent an angel and brought us out of Egypt. And here we are in Kadesh, a city on the edge of your territory. ¹⁷Please let us pass through your land.

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Numbers 20:20-21:

²⁰But he said, “**You shall not pass through.**” And Edom came out against them with a large army and with a strong force. ²¹Thus Edom refused to give Israel passage through his territory, so Israel turned away from him.

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Numbers 20:29:

²⁹And when all the congregation saw that **Aaron had perished**, all the house of Israel wept for Aaron thirty days.

Numbers 21:1-9:

¹When the Canaanite, the king of Arad, who lived in the Negeb, heard that Israel was coming by the way of Atharim, he fought against Israel, and took some of them captive. ²And Israel vowed a vow to the LORD and said, "If you will indeed give this people into my hand, then I will devote their cities to destruction." ³And **the LORD heeded the voice of Israel and gave over the Canaanites**, and they devoted them and their cities to destruction. So the name of the place was called Hormah.

⁴From Mount Hor they set out by the way to the Red Sea, to go around the land of Edom. And the people became impatient on the way. ⁵And the people spoke against God and against Moses, "Why have you brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? For there is no food and no water, and we loathe this worthless food." ⁶Then the LORD sent fiery serpents among the people, and they bit the people, so that many people of Israel died. ⁷And the people came to Moses and said, "We have sinned, for we have spoken against the LORD and against you. Pray to the LORD, that he take away the serpents from us." So Moses prayed for the people. ⁸And the LORD said to Moses, "**Make a fiery serpent and set it on a pole, and everyone who is bitten, when he sees it, shall live.**" ⁹So Moses made a bronze serpent and set it on a pole. And if a serpent bit anyone, he would look at the bronze serpent and live.

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Numbers 21:16-17:

¹⁶And from there they continued to Beer; that is the well of which the LORD said to Moses, "**Gather the people together, so that I may give them water.**"¹⁷ Then Israel sang this song: "Spring up, O well!—Sing to it!"

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Numbers 21:21-24:

²¹Then Israel sent messengers to Sihon king of the Amorites, saying,²² "Let me pass through your land. We will not turn aside into field or vineyard. We will not drink the water of a well. We will go by the King's Highway until we have passed through your territory." ²³But Sihon would not allow Israel to pass through his territory. He gathered all his people together and went out against Israel to the wilderness and came to Jahaz and fought against Israel. ²⁴**And Israel defeated him with the edge of the sword and took possession of his land** from the Arnon to the Jabbok, as far as to the Ammonites, for the border of the Ammonites was strong.

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Numbers 21:31-35:

³¹Thus Israel lived in the land of the Amorites. ³²And Moses sent to spy out Jazer, and they captured its villages and dispossessed the Amorites who were there. ³³Then they turned and went up by the way to Bashan. And Og the king of Bashan came out against them, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei. ³⁴But the LORD said to Moses, "**Do not fear him, for I have given him into your hand, and all his people, and his land.** And you shall do to him as you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon."³⁵ So they defeated him and his sons and all his people, until he had no survivor left. And they possessed his land.

The Changing of Generations

How will you make it home to the new creation?

Story so far...

1) The Problem (C20)

a) **Death** of the 1st generation leaders (20:1, 20:22-29)

b) **Déjà vu** of the people's complaint (20:2–9)

c) **Disobedience** of Moses and Aaron (20:10–13)

d) **Denial** of passage by Edom (20:14–21)

2) The Solution (C21)

a) **Progress**: Geographically and Spiritually in Trusting God (21:1-7)

b) **Provision**: Gracious healing, Trust training, Water providing (21:8-20)

c) **Power**: Victory for those who Trust God (21:21-35)

Application: *How will you make it home to the new creation?*

"¹⁴And as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, so must the Son of Man be lifted up, ¹⁵that whoever believes in him may have eternal life." (John 3:14-15)

-If you are not a Christian... Trust

-If you are a Christian... Keep Trusting

Discussion Questions:

- 1) What trials/temptations in life make it hard for you to trust Jesus on the way home?
- 2) How would your life look different if you keep trusting Jesus amidst the above trials/temptations?